

6.3.6 Batch File

This is a type of script used in Windows and DOS to automate certain tasks. It is essentially a series of instructions that are executed in sequence, and can either be invoked by the user or by a software program, or even when the computer starts up. Similar tasks in other operating systems like the Macintosh OS and UNIX are accomplished by AppleScript and shell commands respectively. See also: Script.

6.3.7 Batch Process

The process of executing a series of instructions in a batch file is known as a batch process. Typically, the batch process is used to execute repeatable tasks that can be tedious to do manually. For example, if you need to copy a particular folder to a backup drive at the end of the day, you would write a batch file with the necessary instructions, and the system would initiate a batch process to copy the files at the end of the day. The execution of the batch process is not limited to just Windows batch files. Any automated task that is set up to run can be considered as a batch process. This could be accomplished by an appropriate scripting language on any operating system. See also: Batch File, Script.

6.3.8 Binary

We normally write numbers in the Base 10 numerical system. Computer processors, however, can recognise only the on or off state of the transistors in the chip. This leads to the need for a compatible system of numerical notation. The binary system is a two-digit numerical system, or a Base 2 system, comprising 1 and 0 (zero). This is much easier for computer systems to manipulate, as the on and off states are easily represented as 1 or 0. And a combination of on and off switches would be the equivalent of a number, a letter, or any other character or group of characters. The number 110 (one-one-zero), for example, is the binary form of the base 10 number 6.

6.3.9 Boolean

To determine if a statement is True or False, computers use Boolean operators. There are four main Boolean operators: AND, NOT, OR,